

Most people prefer to decide for themselves who has their e-mail address. By sending mass mails to a list, you have made that decision for them—and that is a breach of assumed privacy when communicating. Let those you correspond with determine for themselves who they will make their e-mail address known to—do not make that decision for them!

5. If you are new online, raise your right hand and repeat:

A. “I will not forward any dumb joke, ‘chain letter’ or unimportant e-mails to my friends without their permission.”

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B. “I understand that by doing so I may fill up their inbox, use others’ resources unnecessarily, and may cause other, important e-mail to bounce.”

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C. “I understand that most people have seen these e-mails a million times and find them annoying.”

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D. “I know that by forwarding these so-called humorous e-mails

### Tip

Just as in the offline world, online there is also an expectation of socially acceptable behavior and common courtesy. Do not for a moment think that because you are behind a monitor that gives you the excuse to be lazy, rude, crude, obnoxious or just a plain jerk.